

MY SECOND INVESTMENT

AFTER MY FORAY WITH MR. GOLLNER, I HAPPENED TO SEE AN article about psychics and astrologers who give investment advice. I might have ignored it, especially after the omen in the laundromat turned out to be wrong, but when something appears on the business page of the *New York Times* you take it seriously. This article told how various seers, mystics, and familiars had branched out from health and happiness to make predictions on the gold market, the general direction in interest rates, and the future prices of stocks.

Mostly out of curiosity, I decided to contact at least one psychic. I wrote down the names from the article and found a couple of likely phone numbers in the local New York directory. After getting some strange messages from answering machines, I finally tracked down Carole Jayson-Koerber at her home in the suburbs. Somehow, the idea of a psychic in the suburbs seemed more reasonable than a downtown psychic, especially the kind that rents office space around the bus stations and the blood banks.

I had called Ms. Jayson-Koerber, intending to set up an appointment, but something about our conversation made me change my mind. It may have been the dogs barking in the background, or it may have been her telling me that she was terrific at finding bodies for police departments. This shouldn't have bothered me, but for some reason it did. When I suggested that perhaps we shouldn't meet in person after all, she told me she was "auric." Being auric is a newfound skill among psychics that allows them to sense truth over the telephone, thus avoiding the expense and bother of a physical visit. Soon there may be no house calls even among the supernaturals.